Daniel A. Contreras
Associate Professor

daniel.contreras@ufl.edu
dcontre.github.io/academic/
+1 352 294 6880

Department of Anthropology, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL 32611-7305, USA

Daniel Contreras is an anthropological archaeologist who uses geospatial and geoarchaeological approaches to investigate past human-environment interactions over various timescales.

Positions

Associate Professor: 2023-present. Anthropology, University of Florida

Assistant Professor: 2019-2023. Anthropology, University of Florida

Assistant Professor: 2018-19. Anthropology, University of Maryland

OT-Med Postdoctoral Research Fellow: 2014-16. Institut Méditerranéen de Biodiversité et d'Ecologie marine et continentale (IMBE), Aix-Marseille Université

Humboldt Postdoctoral Fellow: 2011-13. Christian-Albrechts-Universität zu Kiel

Postdoctoral Teaching Fellow: 2009-11. Introduction to the Humanities Program, Stanford University

Lecturer: 2007-09. Anthropology, Stanford University

Research Associate: 2008-09. Cultural Heritage Resource, Stanford University

Education

2007: Ph.D., Anthropological Sciences. Stanford University

2004: M.S., Anthropological Sciences. Stanford University

1998: M.A., Latin American Studies. Stanford University

1996: B.A., Religion / Certificate, Latin American Studies. Amherst College

Publications

Journal Articles

1. Vining, B. R., **Contreras,** D. A., Bazán Pérez, A., Garvin Suero, A., García Ortiz, Y., & Rojas, M. L. (2026). Chronology, continuity, and hiatus: Radiocarbon dating of monumental mudbrick architecture in Peru's Chicama Valley. *Journal of Field Archaeology*, 1–20. https://doi.org/10.1080/00934690.2026.2705674
2. Carter, T., **Contreras,** D. A., Mihailović, D. D., Moutsiou, T., Pitt, Y., Singh, N., & Zogheib, C. (2025). Middle Paleolithic behavioral insights from the Stelida chert source, Naxos (Greece). *Journal of Eastern Mediterranean Archaeology and Heritage Studies*, *13*(1–2), 32–59. https://doi.org/10.5325/jeasmedarcherstu.13.1-2.0032
3. **Contreras,** D. A., Marsh, E. J., & Rademaker, K. (2025). Leveraging Radiocarbon in the Central Andes: From chronologies to research agendas. *Quaternary International*, *746*, 109957. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quaint.2025.109957
4. Doering, B. N. (2025). Considering the whole environment in the Arctic past; invited comment by D. **Contreras.** *Current Anthropology*, *66*(2). https://doi.org/10.1086/734760
5. McCool, W. C., Wilson, K. M., Arkush, E. N., **Contreras,** D. A., & Codding, B. F. (2025). Climate stability and low population pressure predict peaceful interactions over 10,000 years of Central Andean history. *Science Advances*, *11*(48), eadt9007.

6. Rick, J. W., Lema, V. S., Echeverría, J., Valverde, G. A., **Contreras,** D. A., Arias Espinoza, O., Rosenfeld, S. A., & Sayre, M. P. (2025). Pre-Hispanic Ritual Use of Psychoactive Plants at Chavín de Huántar, Peru. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America*, *122*(19), e2425125122. https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2425125122
7. Conlee, C. A., **Contreras,** D. A., Peters, A. H., & Vaughn, K. J. (2024). Reconsidering chronologies and cultural change on the south coast of Peru: A compilation and analysis of radiocarbon dates from Nasca, Ica, and Paracas. *Quaternary International*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quaint.2024.06.014
8. **Contreras,** D. A. (2024). Archaeological ^{14}C Assemblages and the Chavín Phenomenon in the Central Andes. *Quaternary International*, *703*, 67–81. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quaint.2024.05.001
9. **Contreras,** D. A., & Codding, B. F. (2024). Landscape Taphonomy Predictably Complicates Demographic Reconstruction. *Journal of Archaeological Method and Theory*, *31*, 1102–1128. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10816-023-09634-5
10. Taffin, N., Lahaye, C., **Contreras,** D. A., Holcomb, J. A., Mihailović, D. D., Karkanas, P., Guérin, G., Athanasoulis, D., & Carter, T. (2024). Chronological and post-depositional insights from single-grain IRSL dating of a Palaeolithic sequence at Stelida, Naxos (Greece). *Journal of Archaeological Science: Reports*, *59*, 104776. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jasrep.2024.104776
11. Carter, T., **Contreras,** D. A., Campeau, K., & Makarewicz, C. A. (2023). Cappadocian obsidian exchange networks in the Pre-Pottery Neolithic A: A southern Levantine perspective from el-Hemmeh (Jordan). *Journal of Archaeological Science: Reports*, *48*, 103857. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jasrep.2023.103857
12. **Contreras,** D. A. (2023). Seeking Synchronicity: Re-examining the Peruvian Early Horizon through Bayesian Modeling of ^{14}C Dates. *Senri Ethnological Studies*, *112*, 127–152. https://doi.org/10.15021/00010048
13. Herndon, K. E., Griffin, R., Schroder, W., Murtha, T., Golden, C., **Contreras,** D. A., Cherrington, E., Wang, L., Bazarsky, A., Kollias, G. V., & Alcover Firpi, O. (2023). Google Earth Engine for Archaeologists: An updated look at the progress and promise of remotely sensed big data. *Journal of Archaeological Science: Reports*, *50*, 104094. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jasrep.2023.104094
14. Sawchuk, E. A., Hildebrand, E. A., Hill, A. C., **Contreras,** D. A., Edung, J. E., Janzen, A., Kurewa, A., Munene, J. K., Ndiema, E., & Grillo, K. M. (2022). The Jarigole Mortuary Tradition Reconsidered. *Antiquity*, *96*(390), 1460–1477. https://doi.org/10.15184/aqy.2022.141
15. Vining, B. R., Hillman, A., & **Contreras,** D. A. (2022). El Niño Southern Oscillation and enhanced arid land vegetation productivity in NW South America. *Journal of Arid Environments*, *198*, 104695. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jaridenv.2021.104695
16. **Contreras,** D. A. (2022). Stages, Periods, and Radiocarbon: ^{14}C Dating in the Archaeology of the Central Andes. *Ñawpa Pacha*, *42*(2), 205–233. https://doi.org/10.1080/00776297.2022.2028389
17. Fitton, T., **Contreras,** D. A., Gidna, A. O., Mabulla, A. Z. P., Prendergast, M. E., & Grillo, K. M. (2022). Detecting and Mapping the "Ephemeral": magnetometric survey of a Pastoral Neolithic settlement at Luxmanda, Tanzania. *Antiquity*, *96*(386), 298–318. https://doi.org/10.15184/aqy.2021.59
18. Silva, F., Coward, F., Davies, K., Elliott, S., Jenkins, E., Newton, A. C., Riris, P., Vander Linden, M., Bates, J., Cantarello, E., **Contreras,** D. A., et al. (2022). Developing Transdisciplinary Approaches to Sustainability Challenges: The Need to Model Socio-Environmental Systems in the Longue Durée. *Sustainability*, *14*(16). https://doi.org/10.3390/su141610234
19. Vining, B. R., Hillman, A., **Contreras,** D. A., & Tejedor, E. (2022). Expanded agroecological niches and redistributed risks in northern Peru's Chicama Valley during late-Holocene ENSO climate changes. *The Holocene*, *32*(12), 1393–1409. https://doi.org/10.1177/09596836221121761
20. Wilson, K. M., McCool, W. C., Brewer, S. C., Zamora-Wilson, N., Schryver, P., Lamson, R. L., Huggard, A., Brenner Coltrain, J., **Contreras,** D. A., & Codding, B. F. (2022). Climate and demography drive 7000 years of dietary change in the Central Andes. *Scientific Reports*, *12*(1), 2026. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-022-05774-y

21. Carter, T., Mallinson, K., Mastrogiannopoulou, V., **Contreras,** D. A., Diffey, C., Lopez, C., Pareja, M. N., Tsartsidou, G., & Athanasoulis, D. (2021). A new Minoan-type peak sanctuary on Stelida, Naxos. *Journal of Greek Archaeology*, *6*, 60–100. https://doi.org/10.32028/9781789698886-5
22. **Contreras,** D. A., Batist, Z., Zogheib, C., & Carter, T. (2021). Matching Pragmatic Lithic Analysis and Proper Data Architecture: The QuARI R Shiny Database Interface. *Advances in Archaeological Practice*, 1–13. https://doi.org/10.1017/aap.2021.11
23. Marsh, E. J., **Contreras,** D., Bruno, M. C., Vranich, A., & Roddick, A. P. (2021). Comment on Arnold et al. "Drought and the collapse of the Tiwanaku Civilization: New evidence from Lake Orurillo, Peru" [Quat. Sci. Rev. 251 (2021): 106693]. *Quaternary Science Reviews*, 107004. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2021.107004
24. Storozum, M. J., Goldstein, S. T., **Contreras,** D. A., Gidna, A. O., Mabulla, A. Z. P., Grillo, K. M., & Prendergast, M. E. (2021). The influence of ancient herders on soil development at Luxmanda, Mbulu Plateau, Tanzania. *CATENA*, *204*, 105376. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.catena.2021.105376
25. **Contreras,** D. A. (2020). Review of Global Perspectives on Long Term Community Resource Management, by Ludomir R. Lozny and Thomas H. McGovern, eds. *Journal of Anthropological Research*, *76*(4), 549–551.
26. Carter, T., **Contreras,** D. A., Holcomb, J., Mihailović, D. D., Karkanas, P., Guérin, G., Taffin, N., Athanasoulis, D., & Lahaye, C. (2019). Earliest Occupation of the Central Aegean (Naxos), Greece: Implications for hominin and Homo sapiens' behavior and dispersals. *Science Advances*, *5*(10), eaax0997. https://doi.org/10.1126/sciadv.aax0997
27. **Contreras,** D. A., Bondeau, A., Guiot, J., Kirman, A., Hiriart, E., Bernard, L., Suarez, R., & Fader, M. (2019). From Paleoclimate Variables to Prehistoric Agriculture: Using a Process-Based Agroecosystem Model to Simulate the Impacts of Holocene Climate Change on Potential Agricultural Productivity in Provence, France. *Quaternary International*, *501B*, 303–316. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quaint.2018.02.019
28. Grillo, K. M., & **Contreras,** D. A. (2019). Public Archaeology's Mammoth in the Room: Engaging Wikipedia as a tool for teaching and outreach. *Advances in Archaeological Practice*, *7*(4), 435–442. https://doi.org/10.1017/aap.2019.8
29. **Contreras,** D. A., Guiot, J., Suarez, R., & Kirman, A. (2018). Reaching the Human Scale: A Spatial and Temporal Downscaling Approach to the Archaeological Implications of Paleoclimate Data. *Journal of Archaeological Science*, *93*, 54–67. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jas.2018.02.013
30. **Contreras,** D. A., Hiriart, E., Bondeau, A., Kirman, A., Guiot, J., Bernard, L., Suarez, R., & Van der Leeuw, S. (2018). Regional Paleoclimates and Local Consequences: Integrating GIS Analysis of Diachronic Settlement Patterns and Process-Based Agro-ecosystem Modeling of Potential Agricultural Productivity in Provence (France). *PLoS ONE*, *13*(12), e0207622. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0207622
31. Grillo, K. M., Prendergast, M. E., **Contreras,** D. A., Fitton, T., Gidna, A. O., Goldstein, S. T., Knisley, M. C., Langley, M. C., & Mabulla, A. Z. (2018). Pastoral Neolithic Settlement at Luxmanda, Tanzania. *Journal of Field Archaeology*, *43*(2), 102–120.
32. Marwick, B., d'Alpoim Guedes, J., Barton, C. M., Bates, L. A., Baxter, M., Bevan, A., Bollwerk, E. A., Bocinsky, R. K., Brughmans, T., Carter, A. K., Conrad, C., **Contreras,** D. A., et al. (2017). Open science in Archaeology. *SAA Archaeological Record*, *17*(4), 8–14.
33. Skarpelis, N., Carter, T., **Contreras,** D. A., & Mihailović, D. D. (2017). Characterization of the siliceous rocks at Stélida, an early prehistoric lithic quarry (Northwest Naxos, Greece), by petrography and geochemistry: A first step towards chert sourcing. *Journal of Archaeological Science: Reports*, *12*, 819–833. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jasrep.2016.11.015
34. Carter, T., **Contreras,** D. A., Campeau, K., & Freund, K. (2016). Spherulites and Aspiring Elites: The identification, distribution, and consumption of Giali Obsidian (Dodecanese, Greece). *Journal of Mediterranean Archaeology*, *29*(1). https://doi.org/10.1558/jmea.v29i1.31011
35. **Contreras,** D. A. (2015). Review of Landesque Capital: The Historical Ecology of Enduring Landscape Modifications, by Thomas Håkansson and Mats Widgren, eds. *Journal of Anthropological Research*, *71*(2), 286–287.

36. **Contreras,** D. A. (2015). Landscape Setting as Medium of Communication at Chavín de Huántar, Peru. *Cambridge Archaeological Journal*, *25*(2), 513–530. https://doi.org/10.1017/s095977431400081x
37. Carter, T., **Contreras,** D. A., Doyle, S., Mihailović, D. D., Moutsiou, T., & Skarpelis, N. (2014). The Stélida Naxos Archaeological Project: new data on the Middle Palaeolithic and Mesolithic Cyclades. *Antiquity*, *88*, 341. https://doi.org/10.15184/S297885520090177X
38. **Contreras,** D. A. (2014). (Re) constructing the sacred: landscape geoarchaeology at Chavín de Huántar, Peru. *Archaeological and Anthropological Sciences*, *9*, 1045–1057. https://doi.org/10.1007/s12520-014-0207-2
39. **Contreras,** D. A., & Meadows, J. (2014). Summed Radiocarbon Calibrations as a Population Proxy: a critical evaluation using a realistic simulation approach. *Journal of Archaeological Science*, *52*, 591–608. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jas.2014.05.030
40. **Contreras,** D. A., Robin, V., Gonda, R., Hodara, R., Corso, M. D., & Makarewicz, C. A. (2014). (Before and) After the Flood: A multiproxy approach to past floodplain usage in the middle Wadi el-Hasa, Jordan. *Journal of Arid Environments*, *110*(C), 30–43. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jaridenv.2014.06.002
41. Carter, T., & **Contreras,** D. A. (2012). The Character and Use of the Soros Hill Obsidian Source, Antiparos (Greece). *Comptes Rendus Palevol*, *11*(8), 595–602. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.crpv.2012.06.005
42. **Contreras,** D. A., Tripcevich, N., & Cavero Palomino, Y. (2012). Investigaciones en la fuente de la obsidiana tipo Quispisisa, Huancasancos- Ayacucho. *Investigaciones Sociales*, *16*(28), 185–195. https://doi.org/10.15381/is.v16i28.7397
43. **Contreras,** D. A. (2011). How far to Conchucos? A GIS approach to assessing the implications of exotic materials at Chavín de Huántar. *World Archaeology*, *43*(3), 380–397. https://doi.org/10.1080/00438243.2011.605841
44. Tripcevich, N., & **Contreras,** D. A. (2011). Quarrying Evidence at the Quispisisa Obsidian Source, Ayacucho, Peru. *Latin American Antiquity*, *22*(1), 121–136. https://doi.org/10.7183/1045-6635.22.1.121
45. **Contreras,** D. A. (2010). Landscape and Environment: Insights from the Prehispanic Central Andes. *Journal of Archaeological Research*, *18*(3), 241–288. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10814-010-9038-6
46. **Contreras,** D. A. (2010). Huaqueros and Remote Sensing Imagery: Assessing Looting Damage in the Virú Valley, Peru. *Antiquity*, *84*(324), 544–555. https://doi.org/10.1017/s0003598x0006676x
47. **Contreras,** D. A. (2010). A Mito-Style Chamber at Chavín de Huántar: Dating and Implications. *Latin American Antiquity*, *21*(1), 1–19. https://doi.org/10.7183/1045-6635.21.1.3
48. **Contreras,** D. A., & Brodie, N. (2010). The Utility of Publicly-available Satellite Imagery for Investigating Looting of Archaeological Sites in Jordan. *Journal of Field Archaeology*, *35*(1), 101–114. https://doi.org/10.1179/009346910x12707320296838
49. **Contreras,** D. A., & Brodie, N. (2010). Shining Light on Looting: Using Google Earth to Quantify Damage and Raise Public Awareness. *SAA Archaeological Record*, *10*(3), 30–33.
50. **Contreras,** D. A. (2009). Reconstructing Landscape at Chavín de Huántar, Perú: A GIS-based approach. *Journal of Archaeological Science*, *36*(4), 1006–1017. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jas.2008.11.025
51. **Contreras,** D. A., & Keefer, D. K. (2009). Implications of the Fluvial History of the Wacheqsa River for Hydrologic Engineering and Water Use at Chavín de Huántar, Peru. *Geoarchaeology*, *24*(5), 589–618. https://doi.org/10.1002/gea.20279
52. Rick, J. W., Mesia, C., **Contreras,** D. A., Kembel, S. R., Rick, R. M., Sayre, M., & Wolf, J. (2009). La cronología de Chavín de Huántar y sus implicancias para el Periodo Formativo. *Boletín de Arqueología PUCP*, *13*, 87–132. https://doi.org/10.18800/boletindearqueologiapucp.200901.003

Books

1. **Contreras,** D. A. (Ed.). (2017). *The Archaeology of Human-Environment Interaction: Strategies for Investigating Anthropogenic Landscapes, Dynamic Environments, and Climate Change in the Human Past*. Routledge. https://doi.org/10.4324/9781315697697
2. **Contreras,** D. A. (2007). *Sociopolitical and Geomorphologic Dynamism at Chavín de Huántar, Peru* [Ph.D. Dissertation, Anthropological Sciences]. Stanford University.

Book Chapters

1. **Contreras,** D. A. (2026). The Chavín Phenomenon and Its Regional Manifestation. In M. Sepulveda, E. G. Neves, & M. S. Aldenderfer (Eds.), *The Oxford Handbook of South American Archaeology* (pp. 527–546). Oxford University Press. https://doi.org/10.1093/oxfordhb/9780195391367.013.36
2. Carter, T., Jackson, N., Moir, R., Allen, P., Burningham, H., **Contreras,** D., Schofield, T., & Tipping, R. (2022). The Freston causewayed enclosure, Suffolk: Initial insight and hypothetical history. In *Marking Place: New perspectives on early Neolithic enclosures* (pp. 81–102). Oxbow Books.
3. **Contreras,** D. A. (2022). Traditions émergentes: Chavín et Cupisnique. In B. Faug'ere & N. Goepfert (Eds.), *Atlas de l'Amérique précolombienne* (pp. 56–57). Éditions Autrement.
4. **Contreras,** D. A., & Meadows, J. (2020). Estudios paleodemográficos basados en conjuntos de dataciones radiométricas. Una revisión crítica. In J. A. Barcel'o & B. Morell (Eds.), *Métodos Cronométricos en Historia y Arqueología* (pp. 493–516). Editorial Dextra.
5. **Contreras,** D. A. (2018). Hacia una geoarqueología del paisaje andina: paisaje, medioambiente, y acción humana en Chavín de Huántar. In L. Flores Blanco (Ed.), *Monumentos, ancestros y tiempo. Una arqueología del paisaje hacia y desde Sudamérica.* Avqi Ediciones.
6. Carter, T., **Contreras,** D. A., Holcomb, J., Mihailović, D. D., Skarpelis, N., Campeau, K., Moutsiou, T., & Athanasoulis, D. (2017). The Stélida Naxos Archaeological Project: New Studies of an Early Prehistoric Chert Quarry in the Cyclades. In D. W. Rupp & J. Tomlinson (Eds.), *From Maple to Olive: Proceedings of a Colloquium to Celebrate the 40th Anniversary of the Canadian Institute in Greece, 10-11 June 2016*. Canadian Institute in Greece.
7. **Contreras,** D. A. (2017). Not Just a Pyramid Scheme? Diversity in Ritual Architecture at Chavín de Huántar. In S. A. Rosenfeld & S. L. Bautista (Eds.), *Rituals of the Past: Prehispanic and Colonial Case Studies in Andean Archaeology* (pp. 51–78). University Press of Colorado. https://doi.org/10.5876/9781607325963.c003
8. **Contreras,** D. A. (2017). Correlation is Not Enough – Building Better Arguments in the Archaeology of Human-Environment Interactions. In D. A. **Contreras** (Ed.), *The Archaeology of Human-Environment Interaction: Strategies for Investigating Anthropogenic Landscapes, Dynamic Environments, and Climate Change in the Human Past* (pp. 3–22). Routledge.
9. **Contreras,** D. A., & Makarewicz, C. A. (2017). Regional Climate, Local Paleoenvironment, and Early Cultivation at Pre-Pottery Neolithic A el-Hemmeh, Jordan. In D. A. **Contreras** (Ed.), *The Archaeology of Human-Environment Interactions: Strategies for Investigating Anthropogenic Landscapes, Dynamic Environments, and Climate Change in the Human Past* (pp. 96–120). Routledge.
10. Carter, T., **Contreras,** D. A., Doyle, S., Mihailović, D. D., & Skarpelis, N. (2016). Early Holocene interaction in the Aegean Islands: Mesolithic chert exploitation at Stélida (Naxos, Greece) in context. In M. Ghilardi (Ed.), *Géoarchéologie des îles de la Méditerranée* (pp. 275–286). CNRS Éditions.
11. **Contreras,** D. A. (2016). La incorporación de la tradición Mito en el ámbito ritual de Chavín de Huántar. In B. Ibarra (Ed.), *Arqueología de la sierra de Ancash 2: Cronología y espacio* (pp. 29–52). Instituto de Estudios Huarinos.

12. Brodie, N., & **Contreras,** D. A. (2012). The economics of the looted archaeological site of Bâb edh-Dhrâ': a view from Google Earth. In P. K. Lazrus & A. W. Barker (Eds.), *All The Kings Horses: Essays on the Impact of Looting and the Illicit Antiquities Trade on Our Knowledge of the Past* (pp. 9–24). Society for American Archaeology Press. https://doi.org/10.5876/9781646425112.c002
13. Tripcevich, N., & **Contreras,** D. A. (2012). Archaeological Approaches to Obsidian Quarries: Investigations at the Quispisisa Source. In N. Tripcevich & K. J. Vaughn (Eds.), *Mining and Quarrying in the Ancient Andes: Sociopolitical, Economic and Symbolic Dimensions* (pp. 23–44). Springer. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-1-4614-5200-3_2
14. **Contreras,** D. A. (2010). Reconstructing an Engineered Environment in the Central Andes: Landscape Geoarchaeology at Chavín de Huántar, Peru. In R. M. Dean (Ed.), *The Archaeology of Anthropogenic Environments* (pp. 225–249). Center for Archaeological Investigations, Southern Illinois University.
15. **Contreras,** D. A. (2008). Geomorfología y Paisaje en Chavín de Huántar. In *Museo Nacional Chavín* (pp. 50–59). Instituto Nacional de Cultura.

Book Reviews

1. **Contreras,** D. A. (2020). Review of Lozny and McGovern, eds., Global Perspectives on Long Term Community Resource Management. *Journal of Anthropological Research*, *76*(4), 549–551.
2. **Contreras,** D. A. (2015). Review of Håkansson and Widgren, eds., Landesque Capital: The Historical Ecology of Enduring Landscape Modifications. *Journal of Anthropological Research*, *71*(2), 286–287.

In press

1. **Contreras,** D. A., Acero-Shapiama, E. E., Rosenfeld, S. A., Sayre, M. P., Wolf, J., & Rick, J. W. Chronologies of Interaction: Assessing the ^{14}C Evidence of the Chavín Phenomenon. *Senri Ethnological Studies*.
2. **Contreras,** D. A., & Rojas-Pelayo, L. Hacia una historia espacial de las intervenciones arqueológicas en Chavín de Huántar. In C. M. Molina Gordillo & N. L. Haro Carrasco (Eds.), *Actas del simposio internacional: Chavín, 100 años de arqueología*. Museo Nacional de Chavín.
3. **Contreras,** D. A., & Tripcevich, N. Retrospect and Prospect for Obsidian Sourcing Studies in the Central Andes. In F.-X. Le Bourdonnec, M. Orange, & M. S. Shackley (Eds.), *Sourcing Obsidian*. Springer.
4. Carter, T., Tsartsidou, G., Mallinson, K., Mastrogiannopoulou, V., **Contreras,** D. A., Mylona, D., & Athanasoulis, D. The impact of the Theran eruption on the Stelida peak sanctuary and later Bronze Age Naxos. In J. Driessen (Ed.), *Tephra. The Presence and Effects of Santorini Volcanic Ash in the Late Bronze Aegean*. Presses Universitaires de Louvain.

Grants and Fellowships

2026: **Enriching radiocarbon databases to reconceive archaeological time (with Erik J. Marsh [CONICET])**.
CfAS Synthesis Design Workshop Grant, submitted.

2026: **ARCHETime: Radiocarbon Collaborative for South American Heritage and Environmental Timelines**.
European Cooperation in Science and Technology (eCost), Secondary proposer with main proposer A. Rakowski; total 31 proposers from 14 countries; OC-2025-1-28822; CA25126, €600,000.

2024: **Archaeological Research at Chavín de Huántar, Ancash, Peru**.
University of Florida Research Tutorial Abroad, $12000.

2022: **Doctoral Dissertation Improvement Award: Human Adaptation to a Variable Environment**.
National Science Foundation Archaeology Program Doctoral Dissertation Improvement Grant, PI with co-PI Rocío López; Award 2227230, $28313.

2022: **Dates as Metadata: How Disciplinary History Shapes Central Andean Archaeology**.
UF Humanities Scholarship Enhancement Fund research award, $11791.

2019: **Collaborative Research: Improved Taphonomic Correction of Past Population Dynamics**.
National Science Foundation Archaeology Program Grant, PI with Brian Codding, co-PI; Award 1921013, $79465.

2019: **Collaborative Research: Coupling and Cohesion as Factors Affecting Vulnerability to Abrupt Climate Change**.
National Science Foundation Archaeology Program Grant, co-PI with Ben Vining [PI] and Aubrey Hillman [co-PI]; Award 1847131, $26155.

2011: **Prehispanic Exploitation of Obsidian at the Quispisisa Source, Ayacucho, Peru**.
National Geographic Society Committee for Research and Exploration, with Nicholas Tripcevich, Grant #8916-11, $23,000.

2011: **Long-term Human Occupation of the Upper Río Caracha, Ayacucho, Peru**.
Brennan Foundation Program in Support of Archaeological Field Research in the Development of Early Civilizations, $5000.

2010: **Landscape Modification, Subsistence, and Sustainability in the Prehispanic New World**.
Council of American Overseas Research Centers Multi-Country Research Fellowship, $10000.

Awards

University of Florida

2022

- Dunlevie Honors Term Professor

Teaching and Mentoring

Courses

University of Florida *(Anthropology*, 2019-present)

- Digital Methods in Archaeology; Past Human Environments; R for Archaeological Data Analysis and Visualization; Advanced Computational Archaeology; Foundations for a Career in Anthropology; Archaeological Perspectives on the Anthropocene; Environmental Archaeology; Geoarchaeology; GIS for Archaeological Research; Global Prehistory: Postglacial Environments and the Origins of Food Production; 1491: The World Columbus Found and How We Know It

University of Maryland *(Anthropology*, 2018-2019)

- Introduction to Archaeology; Quantification and Statistics in Applied Anthropology

Stanford University *(Anthropology/Archaeology/Introduction to the Humanities*, 2006-2011)

- World Archaeology and Global Heritage; Past Human Environments; Applying GIS in Anthropological Research; Laws and Orders; Digital Methods in Archaeology; Introduction to Peruvian Prehistory; Archaeology as a Profession; Humanized Landscapes: Archaeological Approaches to Human-Environment Interactions, Advanced Andean Archaeology; Models and Images in Archaeological Computing

Theses Supervised

Ph.D.
Anthropology, University of Florida

- Amanda Brock - *Making Monumental Places in Dynamic Landscapes: A Case in the Callejón de Huaylas, Peru* (2024),
- Rocío López - *A Geoarchaeological Approach to the Materiality and Historical Ecology of Earth Mounds: The Colina Da Monte Site, Uruguay* (2024),

B.A. Honors
Anthropology, University of Florida

- Talia Nishida - *Obsidian Sourcing and Interaction Networks in the Tanzanian Pastoral Neolithic* (2026), Awarded *Summa cum laude*
- Jacob Roberts - *Households and the Residential in the Central Andean Middle-Late Formative Period; Defining the Domestic at La Banda, Chavín de Huántar, Peru* (2025), Awarded *Summa cum laude*
- Elizabeth Ramshaw - *Living with the Monument: Domestic Architecture, Spatial Planning, and Integration at La Banda, Chavín de Huántar* (2025), Awarded *Magna cum laude*
- Sarah Schmitt - *Taking A Closer Look at La Banda: Utilizing Photogrammetry to Explore Domestic Life at Chavín de Huántar* (2024), Awarded *Summa cum laude*

Professional Service

2026: **Graduate Education Committee**, Anthropology Department, University of Florida.

2026: **Advisory Committee**, Anthropology Department, University of Florida.

2026: **Written Testimony**, advocating renewal of the CPAC (Cultural Property Advisory Committee) Bilateral Agreement between the U.S. and Peru (with Kurt Wilson).

2024: **Interim Graduate Coordinator**, Anthropology Department, University of Florida.

2024: **consultation**, Homeland Security Investigations (HSI), on authentication of Peruvian cultural property.

2023: **Graduate Financial Aid Committee**, Anthropology Department, University of Florida.

2023: **co-editor**, *Archaeological Radiocarbon in the Central Andes*, Special Issue of *Quaternary International*.

2022 - present: **Review Editor**, *Frontiers in Environmental Archaeology*, Landscape and Geological Processes section.

2022 – present: **Invited member**, Consejo Editorial Internacional, *Boletín de Arqueología PUCP* [International Editorial Council, Archaeological Bulletin of the Pontifica Universidad Católica del Perú].

2022-24: **Research Misconduct Committee**, University of Florida.

2022 - present: **Proposal review**, Agence Nationale de Recherche (France), American Philosophical Society Lewis and Clark Fund for Exploration and Field Research, European Research Council, FONCyT (La Comisión de Ciencias Humanas del Fondo para la Investigación Científica y Tecnológica, Argentina), Fundación Wiese (Perú), KU Leuven Research Council (Belgium), National Science Centre Poland.

2007 – present: **Peer review**, *Advances in Archaeological Practice; Ancient Mesoamerica; Andean Past, Antiquity, Archaeological and Anthropological Sciences, Archaeometry, Arqueología y Sociedad, Arqueología, Arqueológicas, Boletín de Arqueología PUCP, Cambridge Archaeological Journal, Chungara: Revista de Antropología Chilena, Current Anthropology, Environmental Archaeology, Frontiers in Environmental Archaeology, Geosciences, The Holocene, International Journal of Cultural Property, Journal of Anthropological Archaeology, Journal of Archaeological Method and Theory, Journal of Archaeological Research, Journal of Archaeological Science, Journal of Archaeological Science: Reports, Journal of Cultural Heritage, Journal of Field Archaeology, Journal of Island and Coastal Archaeology, Journal of Open Archaeological Data, Journal of World Prehistory, Landscape Research, Latin American Antiquity, Nature Communications, Ñawpa Pacha: Journal of Andean Archaeology, Open Quaternary, PNAS, Quaternary, Quaternary International, Radiocarbon, Remote Sensing, Sustainability, Water*.

2022: **Co-chair**, *Leveraging Radiocarbon in the Central Andes: From Chronologies to Research Agendas*, Symposium for the 86th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meeting, Chicago, IL.

2022 - present: **Manuscript review**, University of Arizona Press, Boundary End Archaeology Research Center, Routledge.

2022: **Fieldwork Festival Committee**, Latin American Studies, University of Florida.

2021 - present: **Invited member**, Comité Consultivo de Investigación Arqueológica del Complejo Arqueológico El Brujo [Consulting Committee on Archaeological Research, El Brujo Archaeological

Complex].

2021: **Review Committee**, Institute of Andean Studies 62nd Annual Meeting.

2021 - present: **Public Archaeology MA Committee**, Anthropology Department, University of Florida.

2020-22: **Faculty Council**, College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, University of Florida.

2020 - 2023: **Graduate Education Committee**, Anthropology Department, University of Florida.

2020: **Member**, Society for American Archaeology Program Committee.

2019: **Co-chair**, *An Archaeological Example: Celebrating John Rick's Research and Teaching Career*, Symposium at the 84th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meeting, Albuquerque, NM.

2018 – 2021: **Member**, Scientific Committee, Historical Ecology for the Future: International conference on historical ecology.

2017 – 2021: **Member**, Institute of Andean Studies 14C Grant Committee.

2017 – 2021: **Member**, Open Science Interest Group, Society for American Archaeology.

2016 – 2021: **Member**, PAGES LandCover6k Working Group.

2014: **Chair**, *Correlation Is Not Enough: Building Better Arguments in the Archaeology of Human-Environment Interactions*, Symposium at the 79th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meeting, Austin, TX.

Archaeological Field Research

2019 - present: **co-PI (with Benjamin Vining, U Arkansas and Aubrey Hillman, SUNY Albany)**, Chicama Environmental Archaeology Project.

2019 - present: **Consulting member**, Programa de Investigación y Conservación Chavín de Huántar (P.I. John Rick, Stanford University).

2026: **Project Geospatial Specialist and Geoarchaeologist**, Later Prehistory of West Turkana Project, Lokam, Kenya (P.I.s Elisabeth Hildebrand, Stony Brook University and Kate Grillo, U Florida).

2019: **Project Geospatial Specialist and Geoarchaeologist**, Later Prehistory of West Turkana Project, Jarigole, Kenya (P.I.s Elisabeth Hildebrand, Stony Brook University, Elizabeth Sawchuk, Stony Brook University, and Kate Grillo, U Florida).

2013 – 2019: **Field Director**, Stélida Naxos Archaeological Project, Naxos, Greece (P.I. Tristan Carter, McMaster University).

2010 – 2018: **Project Geoarchaeologist**, The el-Hemmeh Excavation Project, Wadi al-Hasa, Jordan (P.I. Cheryl Makarewicz, CAU Kiel).

2016 – 2018: **Project Geoarchaeologist**, Sharara Excavation Project, Wadi al-Hasa, Jordan (P.I.s Cheryl Makarewicz, CAU Kiel and Bill Finlayson, CBRL).

2015 – 2018: **Project Geospatial Specialist and Geoarchaeologist**, Northern Tanzania Archaeological Project, Luxmanda, Tanzania (P.I.s Kate Grillo, U Florida and Mary Prendergast, Rice University).

2012: **Project Geoarchaeologist**, Stanford-Universidad del Valle Semetabaj Project, San Andres Semetebaj, Guatemala (P.I.s John Rick, Stanford University and Tomás Barrientos, Universidad del Valle).

2009 – 2012: **co-Director (with Nicholas Tripcevich, U.C. Berkeley)**, Proyecto Arqueológico Caracha Alta, Ayacucho, Peru.

2010 – 2013: **Project Geoarchaeologist**, McMaster Obsidian Procurement Expedition (P.I. Tristan Carter, McMaster University).

2010: **Geoarchaeological Consultant**, Remote Detection of Hydraulic Agricultural Features at Teotihuacan, Teotihuacan, Mexico (P.I. Ian Robertson, Stanford University).

2009: **Geoarchaeological Consultant**, Proyecto Arqueológico Stanford, Chavín de Huántar, Peru (P.I. John Rick, Stanford University).

2009: **co-Director (with Neil Brodie, Stanford University)**, Ground-truthing Satellite-identified Looting Damage in Jordan.

2007: **Field Consultant**, Proyecto Arqueológico Queneto, Valle de Virú, Peru (P.I. Ignacio Cancino, Stanford University).

2002 – 2006: **Field Director**, Proyecto Arqueológico Stanford, Chavín de Huántar, Peru (P.I. John Rick, Stanford University).

2004-2005: **Field Supervisor**, Stanford-Universidad del Valle Semetabaj Project, San Andres Semetebaj, Guatemala (P.I. John Rick, Stanford University and Luisa Escobar Galo, Lic., Universidad del Valle).

2003: **Field Supervisor**, Stanford Field School, Çatalhüyük Archaeological Project, Çatalhüyük, Turkey (P.I. Ian Hodder, Stanford University).

1998, 2000: **Field Assistant**, Proyecto Arqueológico Stanford, Chavín de Huántar, Peru (P.I. John Rick, Stanford University).

1995: **Student**, Proyecto Arqueológico Valle de Naco, Cofradía, Honduras (P.I.s Ed Schortman and Pat Urban, Kenyon College).

Presentations (last 5 years)

1. **Contreras,** D. A., & Codding, B. F. (2026). Are we underestimating Paleoindian populations? Landscape Taphonomy and Dates-as-Data in the Bonneville Basin. *Paleoamerican Odyssey*.
2. **Contreras,** D. A. (2026). What are radiocarbon dates proxies for? Dates-as-data and monumental construction in the Chicama Valley, Peru. *Thinking Archaeology Through Its Methods: Reflections on Time, Practice, and Evidence*.
3. **Contreras,** D. A., Vining, B., & Bazán, A. (2026). What Are Radiocarbon Dates Proxies For? Dates-as-Data and Monumental Construction in the Chicama Valley, Peru. *Maritime Foundations for Andean Civilization at 50: Whither the Tides? , 91st Annual Society for American Archaeology Meetings*.
4. Rojas-Pelayo, L., Acero-Shapiama, E., **Contreras,** D. A., Rick, R., & Rick, J. (2026). From Notes to Maps: A Legacy GIS Approach for Examining Mariash-Recuay Transformations at Chavín de Huántar. *91st Annual Society for American Archaeology Meetings*.
5. **Contreras,** D. A. (2026). *Big Data Approaches to Andean Archaeology, 91st Annual Society for American Archaeology Meetings*.
6. **Contreras,** D. A., Hernandez, D., Wilson, K., Gauthier, N., & Codding, B. (2025). Species Distribution Modeling of Monumentality: Exploratory analysis of the maritime foundations of Andean civilization. *45es Rencontres Internationales d'Archéologie Et d'Histoire de Nice Côte d'Azur*.
7. Nishida, T., **Contreras,** D. A., Seitsonen, O., Mabulla, A., Gidna, A., Grillo, K. M., & Prendergast, M. E. (2025). Obsidian sourcing and interaction networks in the Tanzanian Pastoral Neolithic. *Society for Africanist Archaeology (SAfA) Meetings*.
8. **Contreras,** D. A. (2025). Chronologies of Interaction: Bayesian Modeling of the Chavín Phenomenon. *Social Dynamics in the North Highlands of Peru During the Formative Period: The Pacopampa Project's Contribution to Understanding the Early Complex Societies in the Andes, 90th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meetings*.
9. Roberts, J. R., Elizabeth Ramshaw, C. C. and, Schmitt, S., Matt Sayre, J. E.-C. and, Rosenfeld, S., John Wolf, E. A.-S. and, Rick, J. W., & **Contreras,** D. A. (2025). Defining the Domestic at Chavín de Huántar: Learning from the La Banda Sector. *90th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meetings*.
10. Ramshaw, E., Schmitt, S., Roberts, J., Cornejo, C., Erickson-Cartaya, J., Sayre, M., Rosenfeld, S., Acero, E., Wolf, J., Rick, J. W., & **Contreras,** D. A. (2025). Integrating Two Decades of Disparate Data from the La Banda Sector at Chavín de Huántar: From Pole Aerial Photography to UAV Photogrammetry via Plan Drawings. *90th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meetings*.

11. Nishida, T., **Contreras,** D. A., Seitsonen, O., Grillo, K. M., & Prendergast, M. E. (2025). Obsidian Sourcing and Interaction Networks in the Tanzanian Pastoral Neolithic. *90th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meetings.*
12. **Contreras,** D. A., Nishida, T., Grillo, K. M., & Prendergast, M. E. (2025). Asking Questions with Obsidian at Luxmanda (+). *What's Cooking in the Pastoral Neolithic.*
13. **Contreras,** D. A. (2024). Aportes a la interpretación del fenómeno Chavín del análisis de los conjuntos de fechados radiocarbónicos. *Congreso Nacional de Arqueología.*
14. **Contreras,** D. A., Sayre, M., Rosenfeld, S., Wolf, J., Acero, E., Rojas-Pelayo, L., Schmitt, S., & Rick, J. W. (2024). Searching for the Domestic at Chavín: Integrating 20-Plus years of Archaeology in La Banda. *Chavín de Huántar's Contribution to Understanding the Central Andean Formative: Results and Perspectives, 89th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meetings.*
15. **Contreras,** D. A. (2023). Examining Peru's Early Horizon through Bayesian Modeling of the Radiocarbon Evidence. *CLARa2 (Second Latin American Radiocarbon Conference).*
16. **Contreras,** D. A., & Codding, B. (2023). Density Dependent Models Rely on Accurate Population Estimates. *88th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meetings.*
17. Vining, B., **Contreras,** D. A., & Bazán, A. (2023). Beyond Coarse Correlations: Climate, Chronology, and Culture in Chicama, Peru. *88th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meetings.*
18. **Contreras,** D. A. (2022). El carbono 14 y modelamiento bayesiano en la arqueología andina. *VIII Coloquio Internacional de Arqueologia de La Fundación Wiese.*
19. **Contreras,** D. A. (2022). Balances y perspectivas sobre cronologías de la Costa Norte del Perú. *VIII Coloquio Internacional de Arqueologia de La Fundación Wiese.*
20. **Contreras,** D. A. (2022). Clearing the View of the Early Horizon. *Leveraging Radiocarbon in the Central Andes: From Chronologies to Research Agendas, 87th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meeting.*
21. **Contreras,** D. A. (2022). Do Archaeologists Know Sustainability When They See It? *Lessons from the Past: Archaeological Insights on Environmental, Economic, and Social Sustainability, , 87th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meeting.*
22. Wilson, K., Codding, B., McCool, W., **Contreras,** D. A., & Coltrain, J. B. (2022). Climate Change Drives 7,000 Years of Dietary Variation in the Central Andes. *Climatic Influences on Diet, Demography, and Conflict, 87th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meeting.*
23. Vining, B., **Contreras,** D. A., & Hillman, A. (2022). Archaeological and Ecological Evidence for El Niño-Driven Expansion of Agroecological Niches on Peru's North Coast. *El Niño and the Archaeology of Resilience on the Peruvian Coast, 87th Annual Society for American Archaeology Meeting.*
24. **Contreras,** D. A., & Codding, B. (2021). *Identifying Human Responses to Holocene Climate Change: Population, Environment, and Landscape Taphonomy in the Bonneville Basin, Utah* [Invited talk for Seminar Series].
25. **Contreras,** D. A., & Codding, B. (2021). *Identifying Human Responses to Holocene Climate Change: Population, Environment, and Landscape Taphonomy in the Bonneville Basin, Utah* [Invited talk for Research Seminar].
26. **Contreras,** D. A., Vining, B., & Hillman, A. (2021). Working from Regional Climates towards Local Consequences: Diachronic Settlement Patterns as Model Material in the Chicama Valley, Peru. *RDMed Workshop: Modelling Adaptation of Ancient Agricultural Societies to Climate Change, the Core of an Interdisciplinary Approach,.*
27. **Contreras,** D. A., & Vining, B. (2021). Assembling the Archive: Integrating Legacy Data to Examine the Longue Durée in the Chicama Valley, Peru. *61st Annual Meetings of the Institute of Andean Studies.*

Professional Memberships

Society for American Archaeology.

Institute of Andean Studies.

Institute of Andean Research.
International Association for Obsidian Studies.

Languages

Native speaker of English.
Written and oral fluency in Spanish.
Intermediate French (B1).